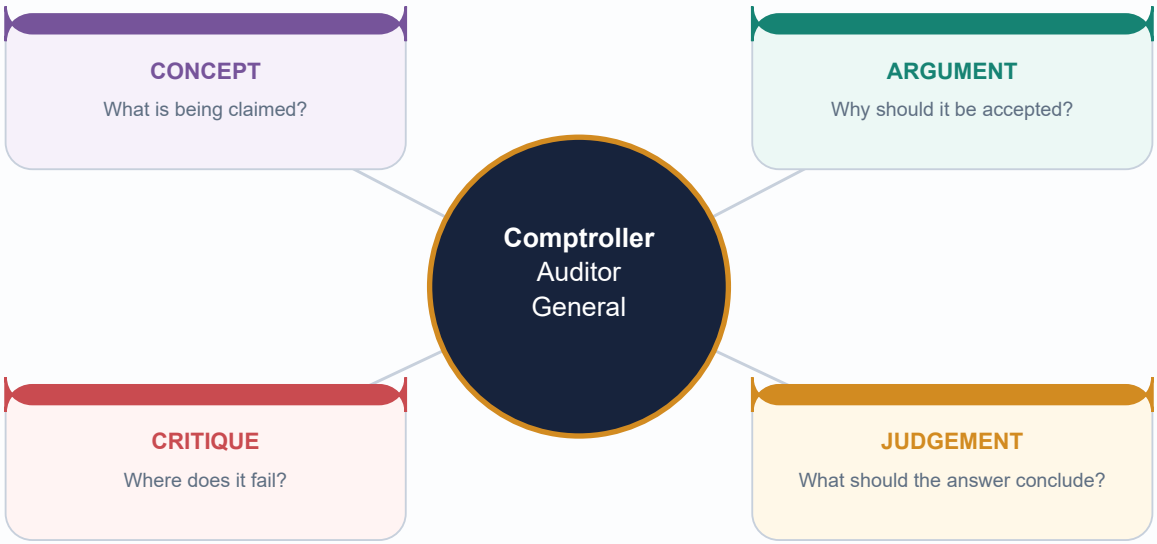
UPSC INDIAN POLITY

Comptroller & Auditor General (CAG) (Articles 148–151) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE Deep-Learning Visual Notes

Indian Polity · GS Paper II · Prelims + Mains
Layer 1: Basic foundation · Layer 2: Advanced constitutional and exam depth
Sources: CAG.md + 32_CAG.md
Learning cards: 43



Facts from official sources | Inferences clearly marked | No fabricated data

HIGH UPSC RELEVANCE

HIGH

Foundation · Core Foundation

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Subject: Polity · **Tier:** Basic (foundation) · **GS-II**

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

STATIC THEORY

- □ = from book · □ = current link · □ = mnemonic. *Advanced: optional deeper detail in advanced/32_CAG.md — not required for any mark.*

MEMORY HOOK

□ = from book · □ = current link · = mnemonic. *Advanced: optional deeper detail in advanced/32_CAG.md — not required for any mark.*

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. = from book · □ = current link · □ = mnemonic. *Advanced: optional deeper detail in advanced/32_CAG.md — not required for any mark.*

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Comptroller & Auditor General (CAG) (Articles 148–151) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Core Foundation

HIGH

Foundation · Snapshot

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Item	Fact
Articles	**148–151** (+ 279 net proceeds)
Appointed by	**President**
Term	**6 years or 65 years**, whichever earlier
Removal	Like a **Supreme Court judge**
Law	**CAG's (DPC) Act, 1971**

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Comptroller & Auditor General (CAG) (Articles 148–151) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Snapshot

HIGH

Foundation · Core idea

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

The CAG is the **"guardian of the public purse"** and an independent constitutional audit authority — it audits public finances within its legal mandate and reports through the constitutional route to legislatures, securing executive financial accountability. Ambedkar called him **"the most important officer under the Constitution."**

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

CORE IDEA: RECALL MAP

Core idea

V

Dimension 1 The CAG is the "guardian of the public purse" and an independent constitutional audit authority — it audits public finances within its legal mandate a	**Dimension 2** □ Comptroller in name only — India's CAG audits after spending (no control over money issue, unlike
Dimension 3 Britain).	**Dimension 4** □ Reports: Centre → President → Parliament; State → Governor → State Legislature.

STATIC THEORY

- □ **Comptroller in name only** — India's CAG audits **after** spending (no control over money issue, unlike

- Britain).

- □ **Reports:** Centre → **President** → **Parliament**; State → **Governor** → **State Legislature**.

MEMORY HOOK

Comptroller in name only — India's CAG audits after spending (no control over money issue, unlike | Reports: Centre → President → Parliament; State → Governor → State Legislature.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Comptroller & Auditor General (CAG) (Articles 148–151) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Core idea

HIGH

Foundation · Must-Know Facts

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ Salary = **Supreme Court judge**; expenses **charged on the CFI**.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MUST-KNOW FACTS: RECALL MAP

Must-Know Facts

V

Dimension 1 □ Salary = Supreme Court judge; expenses charged on the CFI.	**Dimension 2** □ Not eligible for any further govt office after retirement.
Dimension 3 □ Major report families include appropriation/finance-account audit and sector/entity-specific reports; there is no immutable constitutional list of e	**Dimension 4** □ Guide, friend & philosopher of the PAC (Public Accounts Committee).

STATIC THEORY

- □ **Not eligible for any further govt office** after retirement.

- □ Major report families include appropriation/finance-account audit and sector/entity-specific reports; there is no immutable constitutional list of exactly three reports.

- □ **Guide, friend & philosopher of the PAC** (Public Accounts Committee).

- □ **Legal/regulatory audit** = obligatory; **propriety audit** = discretionary.

- □ Public corporations and government companies follow entity-specific statutes and the DPC/Companies Act routes; never infer CAG coverage or exclusion from the entity label alone.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Salary = **Supreme Court judge**; expenses **charged on the CFI**.

2. Not eligible for any further govt office after retirement.

3. Major report families include appropriation/finance-account audit and sector/entity-specific reports; there is no immutable constitutional list of exactly three reports.

4. Guide, friend & philosopher of the PAC (Public Accounts Committee).

5. Legal/regulatory audit = obligatory; **propriety audit** = discretionary.

6. Public corporations and government companies follow entity-specific statutes and the DPC/Companies Act routes; never infer CAG coverage or exclusion from the entity label alone.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Comptroller & Auditor General (CAG) (Articles 148–151) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Must-Know Facts

HIGH

Foundation · □ Current link

GS-II Indian Polity

NEWS TRIGGER

□ □□ Debate on extending CAG audit to **PPP projects, off-budget borrowings & PM-CARES**; demand for a **collegium-style appointment** to strengthen the CAG's independence.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of □ Current link.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Comptroller & Auditor General (CAG) (Articles 148–151) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → □ Current link

HIGH

Foundation · Answer architecture (10/15/20-mark support)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of Answer architecture (10/15/20-mark support).

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

Purpose: make this Core file independently answer directive-sensitive GS-II questions on the CAG's appointment, tenure and removal safeguard, the audit powers under Articles 148–151 and the DPC Act 1971, the legality-vs-propriety debate and the audit-reach controversies — without opening Advanced.

STUDY LINK

Comptroller & Auditor General (CAG) (Articles 148–151) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Answer architecture (10/15/20-mark support)

HIGH

Foundation · 5.0 Direct Mains demands owned by this Core file

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of 5.0 Direct Mains demands owned by this Core file.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

2018 · GS-II · Q5 *— Demand (neutral rendering): the method of appointment, the terms of office and the range of powers of the CAG. Directive:* ***Explain · 10 marks · 150 words. Core routing supersedes the older advanced/32_CAG.md pointer for this demand. Executable route:*** *(1)* ***Appointment*** *—* ***Art 148****: appointed by the* ***President*** *by warrant under hand and seal; the executive appoints, with no prescribed collegium. (2)* ***Terms*** *—* ***6 years or 65 years****, whichever earlier; salary and service conditions equal to a* ***Supreme Court judge****, determined by Parliament and* ***not variable to disadvantage****; salary and administrative expenses* ***charged on the Consolidated Fund of India****;* ***removable only like a Supreme Court judge*** *(address of both Houses by special majority on proved misbehaviour/incapacity), and* ***barred from any further office*** *under the Union or a State. (3)* ***Powers*** *— under* ***Art 149*** *and the* ***CAG's (DPC) Act, 1971*** *the CAG audits the* ***Consolidated Fund, Contingency Fund and Public Account*** *of the Union/States, all receipts and expenditure,* ***government companies****, corporations and* ***bodies substantially financed*** *from public funds;* ***Art 150*** *— advises on the* ***form of accounts****;* ***Art 151*** *— submits reports to the* ***President*** *→* ***Parliament*** *(and Governor → State legislature);* ***Art 279*** *— certifies the* ***net proceeds*** *of a tax, finally. (4)* ***Limits*** *—* ***"Comptroller in name only"*** *(no control over the issue of money), secret-service expenditure, and propriety audit only discretionary. (5)* ***Verdict*** *— a constitutionally insulated auditor whose weakness lies at the appointment end, not the tenure end.* ***2024 · GS-II · Q4*** *— Demand (neutral rendering): the CAG's duty is not merely to ensure the legality of expenditure but also its propriety. Directive:* ***Comment · 10 marks · 150 words****.* ***Core routing supersedes the older advanced/32_CAG.md pointer for this demand. Executable route:*** *(1)* ***Position*** *— the CAG's mandate runs beyond legality to propriety and outcomes, but must stop short of substituting its judgement for policy. (2)* ***Legality/regulatory audit*** *—* ***obligatory****: was the money* ***legally available*** *and* ***spent on the sanctioned purpose*** *(appropriation and compliance)? (3)* ***Propriety audit*** *—* ***discretionary****: tests the* ***wisdom, faithfulness and economy*** *of spending, exposing waste, extravagance and conflict of interest beyond mere legality. (4)* ***Performance audit*** *— extends propriety to whether a programme achieved its objectives economically and effectively. (5)* ***Tension*** *— propriety edges toward questioning* ***policy****; the executive resists, but without it legality becomes a formality that cannot catch waste. (6)* ***Verdict*** *— the CAG should audit the* ***propriety of implementation*** *while preserving the elected government's space to choose the* ***policy*** *— legality and propriety are complementary, not rival, duties.*

STUDY LINK

Comptroller & Auditor General (CAG) (Articles 148–151) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.0 Direct Mains demands owned by this Core file

HIGH

Foundation · 5.1 Demand and directive map

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Demand family	Typical directive signals	Answer spine to use
Appointment, tenure, powers	"appointment, terms and powers", Explain	Art 148 appointment → tenure/removal → Art 149–151/DPC Act powers → limits
Legality vs propriety	"not merely legality but propriety", Comment	Regulatory (obligatory) → propriety (discretionary) → performance → policy caution
Independence adequacy	"guardian of the public purse", Examine	Removal/finance safeguards → appointment gap → collegium demand
"Comptroller in name only"	compare with Britain, Critically examine	British ex-ante control → Indian ex-post audit → reform view
Audit-reach controversies	PPP, off-budget, PM-CARES, Discuss	Substantially-financed test → private-fund exclusions → jurisdiction debate

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Comptroller & Auditor General (CAG) (Articles 148–151) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.1 Demand and directive map

HIGH

Foundation · 5.2 Qualified thesis options

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

The CAG is powerfully protected where it works and weakly chosen where it begins: removal is as hard as for a Supreme Court judge, yet appointment is a sole executive act — the reform frontier is the appointment, not the tenure.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

5.2 QUALIFIED THESIS OPTIONS: RECALL MAP

5.2 Qualified thesis options

V

Dimension 1 The CAG is powerfully protected where it works and weakly chosen where it begins: removal is as hard as for a Supreme Court judge, yet appointment is	**Dimension 2** India's CAG is a "Comptroller in name only": unlike Britain's, it cannot stop money leaving the Consolidated Fund and audits only after the fact, whic
Dimension 3 The legality–propriety distinction defines the CAG's reach: legality audit is obligatory and uncontroversial, propriety audit is discretionary and con	**Dimension 4** The CAG's authority is post-facto and advisory, so its effectiveness depends less on its own powers than on the legislative committees that act on its

STATIC THEORY

- India's CAG is a "Comptroller in name only": unlike Britain's, it cannot stop money leaving the Consolidated Fund and audits only after the fact, which makes Parliament — through the PAC and COPU — the real point at which its findings bite.

- The legality–propriety distinction defines the CAG's reach: legality audit is obligatory and uncontroversial, propriety audit is discretionary and contested precisely because it approaches the wisdom of policy.

- The CAG's authority is post-facto and advisory, so its effectiveness depends less on its own powers than on the legislative committees that act on its reports.

- The CAG audits both accounts and outcomes but cannot enforce either; it is the Constitution's most authoritative reporter of financial fact and its least powerful corrector of financial wrong.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Comptroller & Auditor General (CAG) (Articles 148–151) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.2 Qualified thesis options

HIGH

Foundation · 5.3 Mark-scaled structures

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Marks	Architecture	Evidence load
10	Thesis → appointment/tenure or legality/propriety → one limit → verdict	3 units, at least one Article
15	Thesis → status & independence → powers (149–151, DPC Act) → audit types → limits → verdict	5–6 units
20	Thesis → Art 148 design → audit powers & reach → legality/propriety/performance → PAC/COPU route → "Comptroller in name only" & reform → graded verdict	6–8 units + a comparison paragraph

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Comptroller & Auditor General (CAG) (Articles 148–151) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.3 Mark-scaled structures

HIGH

Foundation · 5.4 Bank A — Status, appointment, tenure and independence (Art 148)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Attribute	Position	Caution
□ Legal source	**Art 148**; head of the **Indian Audit & Accounts Department**; the **"guardian of the public purse"** (Ambedkar: "the most important officer under the Constitution")	A single constitutional authority, not a commission
□ Appointment	By the **President** by warrant under hand and seal	**Sole executive** appointment — no prescribed collegium
□ Tenure	**6 years or 65 years**, whichever earlier	Term is fixed by law within the constitutional frame
□ Removal	**Only like a Supreme Court judge** — address of both Houses by special majority on proved misbehaviour/incapacity	**Not** during the President's pleasure
□ Independence	Salary = a **Supreme Court judge**, not variable to disadvantage; salary and office expenses **charged on the CFI**; **no minister** answers for the CAG	□ **Barred from any further office** under the Union or a State (stricter than the UPSC)

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Comptroller & Auditor General (CAG) (Articles 148–151) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.4 Bank A — Status, appointment, tenure and independence (Art 148)

HIGH

Foundation · 5.5 Bank B — Duties and powers (Art 149–151, 279 + DPC Act 1971)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Fund / entity	Within the CAG's audit?
□ Consolidated Fund (Union/State/UT with a legislature)	Yes
□ Contingency Fund and Public Account	Yes
□ Receipts and expenditure; stores and stock	Yes
□ Government companies and corporations	Yes, under the DPC Act read with the Companies Act
□ Bodies substantially financed from public funds	Yes, under the DPC Act (threshold statutory — do not quote a figure)
□ Secret-service expenditure	Only on a **certificate**, not on particulars

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Comptroller & Auditor General (CAG) (Articles 148–151) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.5 Bank B — Duties and powers (Art 149–151, 279 + DPC Act 1971)

HIGH

Foundation · 5.5 Bank B — Duties and powers (Art 149–151, 279 + DPC Act 1971)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Claim → the CAG's powers are constitutional in frame but statutory in detail. □ **Art 149** makes the CAG's duties "as prescribed by Parliament", exercised through the **Comptroller and Auditor General's (Duties, Powers and Conditions of Service) Act, 1971** (amended 1976 to **separate accounts from audit**). → **Mechanism:** the CAG audits the **Consolidated Fund, Contingency Fund and Public Account** of the Union, States and UTs with a legislature; all **receipts and expenditure**; stores and stock; **government companies**; and **bodies/authorities substantially financed** from public funds. → **Limit:** the audit is **ex post** — it reports, it cannot disallow.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

5.5 BANK B — DUTIES AND POWERS (ART 149–151, 279 + DPC ACT 1971): RECALL MAP

5.5 Bank B — Duties and powers (Art 149–151, 279 + DPC Act 1971)

V

Dimension 1
Claim → the CAG's powers are constitutional in frame but statutory in detail. □ Art 149 makes the CAG's duties "as prescribed by Parliament", exercise

Dimension 2
□ Art 150 — the accounts of the Union and States are kept in the form the President prescribes on the CAG's advice.

Dimension 3
□ Art 151 — the CAG's reports on Union accounts go to the President, who lays them before Parliament; State reports go to the Governor and the State l

Dimension 4
□ Art 279 — the CAG ascertains and certifies the net proceeds of a tax, and the certificate is final (the link to the Finance Commission's divisible p

STATIC THEORY

- □ **Art 150** — the accounts of the Union and States are kept in the form the **President prescribes on the CAG's advice**.

- □ **Art 151** — the CAG's reports on Union accounts go to the **President**, who lays them before **Parliament**; State reports go to the **Governor** and the State legislature.

- □ **Art 279** — the CAG **ascertains and certifies** the **net proceeds** of a tax, and the certificate is **final** (the link to the Finance Commission's divisible pool).

- □ **Three reports** to the President: **Appropriation Accounts**, **Finance Accounts**, and **Public Undertakings**.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Claim → the CAG's powers are constitutional in frame but statutory in detail. Art 149 makes the CAG's duties "as prescribed by Parliament", exercised through the **Comptroller and Auditor General's (Duties, Powers and Conditions of Service) Act, 1971** (amended 1976 to **separate accounts from audit**). → **Mechanism:** the CAG audits the **Consolidated Fund, Contingency Fund and Public Account** of the Union, States and UTs with a legislature; all **receipts and expenditure**; stores and stock; **government companies**; and **bodies/authorities substantially financed** from public funds. → **Limit:** the audit is **ex post** — it reports, it cannot disallow.

2. Art 150 — the accounts of the Union and States are kept in the form the **President prescribes on the CAG's advice**.

3. Art 151 — the CAG's reports on Union accounts go to the **President**, who lays them before **Parliament**; State reports go to the **Governor** and the State legislature.

4. Art 279 — the CAG **ascertains and certifies** the **net proceeds** of a tax, and the certificate is **final** (the link to the Finance Commission's divisible pool).

5. Three reports to the President: **Appropriation Accounts**, **Finance Accounts**, and **Public Undertakings**.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Comptroller & Auditor General (CAG) (Articles 148–151) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.5 Bank B — Duties and powers (Art 149–151, 279 + DPC Act 1971)

HIGH

Foundation · 5.6 Bank C — The three kinds of audit

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Audit	Question it asks	Status / caution
□ **Legal / regulatory (compliance)**	Was the money **legally available** and spent on the **sanctioned purpose**?	**Obligatory**
□ **Propriety**	Was the spending **wise, faithful and economical** — free of waste/extravagance?	**Discretionary**; □□ contested because it edges toward **policy wisdom**
□□ **Performance / efficiency**	Did the programme achieve its **objectives economically and effectively**?	The modern expansion; drives "CAG overreach vs accountability" debates

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Comptroller & Auditor General (CAG) (Articles 148–151) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.6 Bank C — The three kinds of audit

HIGH

Foundation · 5.6 Bank C — The three kinds of audit

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Analytical use: the legality/propriety pair is the exact hinge of the 2024 demand — legality is a floor the CAG *must* check; propriety is the discretionary reach that makes audit meaningful, provided it audits *implementation* rather than substituting for *policy*.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Comptroller & Auditor General (CAG) (Articles 148–151) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.6 Bank C — The three kinds of audit

HIGH

Foundation · 5.7 Bank D — Audit reach, exclusions and the accountability route

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Claim → the CAG's reach over the wider public sector is graded, not total. □ Public corporations fall into **three categories**: (i) **audited fully by the CAG**; (ii) **private auditors plus CAG supplementary audit**; and (iii) **exclusively private audit** — the CAG is **not** involved (per the local files, **RBI, LIC, SBI, FCI**). → **Mechanism:** □ **bodies substantially financed** from government funds fall within audit under the **DPC Act** (the financing threshold is statutory — □□ do not quote a figure not in these files). → **Limit:** □ **secret-service expenditure** is audited only on a certificate from the competent authority, not on particulars.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

STATIC THEORY

- **Accountability route:** □ the CAG's reports are examined by the **Public Accounts Committee (PAC)** and the **Committee on Public Undertakings (COPU)**; the CAG is the **"guide, friend and philosopher" of the PAC**. → **Significance:** the CAG **reports**, but **Parliament acts** — the committees are where the findings gain consequence.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Claim → the CAG's reach over the wider public sector is graded, not total. Public corporations fall into **three categories**: (i) **audited fully by the CAG**; (ii) **private auditors plus CAG supplementary audit**; and (iii) **exclusively private audit** — the CAG is **not** involved (per the local files, **RBI, LIC, SBI, FCI**). → **Mechanism: bodies substantially financed** from government funds fall within audit under the **DPC Act** (the financing threshold is statutory — □□ do not quote a figure not in these files). → **Limit: secret-service expenditure** is audited only on a certificate from the competent authority, not on particulars.

2. Accountability route: the CAG's reports are examined by the **Public Accounts Committee (PAC)** and the **Committee on Public Undertakings (COPU)**; the CAG is the **"guide, friend and philosopher" of the PAC**. → **Significance:** the CAG **reports**, but **Parliament acts** — the committees are where the findings gain consequence.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Comptroller & Auditor General (CAG) (Articles 148–151) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.7 Bank D — Audit reach, exclusions and the accountability route

HIGH

Foundation · 5.8 Mechanism, institutional incentives and consequences

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Feature	British CAG	Indian CAG
□ Control over the **issue** of money	Approval needed **before** withdrawal from the Consolidated Fund	**None** — audits **after** expenditure
□ Role	**Comptroller and** Auditor-General	**Auditor-General only**
□ Accounts and audit	Combined	**Separated** (1976 amendment to the DPC Act)

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Comptroller & Auditor General (CAG) (Articles 148–151) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.8 Mechanism, institutional incentives and consequences

HIGH

Foundation · 5.8 Mechanism, institutional incentives and consequences

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Why "Comptroller in name only": □□ unlike the British CAG, whose approval is needed **before** money leaves the Consolidated Fund, India's CAG has **no control over the issue of money** and audits **after** expenditure — it is an **Auditor-General**, not a Comptroller, so its leverage is disclosure, not prevention.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

5.8 MECHANISM, INSTITUTIONAL INCENTIVES AND CONSEQUENCES: RECALL MAP

5.8 Mechanism, institutional incentives and consequences

V

Dimension 1
Why "Comptroller in name only": □□ unlike the British CAG, whose approval is needed before money leaves the Consolidated Fund, India's CAG has no cont

Dimension 2
Why the CAG is an agent of Parliament: □ it is responsible to Parliament, not the executive, which is why reports route through the legislature and wh

Dimension 3
Consequence of ex-post, advisory audit: □□ the CAG can expose but not reverse; effectiveness therefore depends on PAC/COPU follow-up and on media/judi

STATIC THEORY

- **Why the CAG is an agent of Parliament:** □ it is responsible **to Parliament**, not the executive, which is why reports route through the legislature and why no minister may answer for it — the incentive structure ties accountability to the House, not the government.

- **Consequence of ex-post, advisory audit:** □□ the CAG can **expose** but not **reverse**; effectiveness therefore depends on PAC/COPU follow-up and on media/judicial attention, which is uneven.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Why the CAG is an agent of Parliament: it is responsible **to Parliament**, not the executive, which is why reports route through the legislature and why no minister may answer for it — the incentive structure ties accountability to the House, not the government.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Comptroller & Auditor General (CAG) (Articles 148–151) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.8 Mechanism, institutional incentives and consequences

HIGH

Foundation · 5.9 Criticism, counter-argument, variation and implementation constraints

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Overreach critique: □□ propriety and performance audits that estimate "presumptive" losses are accused of straying into **policy** and of arithmetic that assumes a counterfactual; the executive argues audit should test process, not second-guess choices. **(Cite the debate, not any specific loss figure.)**

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

5.9 CRITICISM, COUNTER-ARGUMENT, VARIATION AND IMPLEMENTATION CONSTRAINTS: RECALL MAP

5.9 Criticism, counter-argument, variation and implementation constraints

V

Dimension 1 Overreach critique: □□ propriety and performance audits that estimate "presumptive" losses are accused of straying into policy and of arithmetic that	**Dimension 2** Counter (accountability): □□ without propriety and performance audit, legality becomes a formality unable to catch waste, favouritism or conflict of i
Dimension 3 Appointment critique: □ the sole-executive appointment is criticised; there is a demand for a collegium-style process to strengthen independence.	**Dimension 4** Jurisdiction gaps: □ debate on bringing PPP projects, off-budget borrowings and private-fund entities (e.g. PM-CARES) within audit — the substantially

STATIC THEORY

- **Counter (accountability):** □□ without propriety and performance audit, legality becomes a formality unable to catch waste, favouritism or conflict of interest — the propriety reach is what makes the "guardian of the public purse" meaningful.

- **Appointment critique:** □ the **sole-executive appointment** is criticised; there is a demand for a **collegium-style** process to strengthen independence.

- **Jurisdiction gaps:** □ debate on bringing **PPP projects, off-budget borrowings and private-fund entities (e.g. PM-CARES)** within audit — the **substantially-financed** test is the contested boundary. □□ *Appleby* went the other way, wanting the office abolished as a "negative", colonial inheritance.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Comptroller & Auditor General (CAG) (Articles 148–151) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.9 Criticism, counter-argument, variation and implementation constraints

HIGH

Foundation · 5.10 Verdict scaffolds

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Appointment verdict: "The CAG is insulated at removal but exposed at appointment; strengthening the guardian of the public purse means reforming how it is chosen, not how it is protected."

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

5.10 VERDICT SCAFFOLDS: RECALL MAP

5.10 Verdict scaffolds

V

Dimension 1 Appointment verdict: "The CAG is insulated at removal but exposed at appointment; strengthening the guardian of the public purse means reforming how i	**Dimension 2** Legality-propriety verdict: "Legality is the CAG's floor and propriety its reach; an audit confined to legality would be lawful and useless, while one
Dimension 3 Comptroller verdict: "Because India's CAG audits after the money is gone, its real force is not its own pen but the parliamentary committees that turn	

STATIC THEORY

- **Legality-propriety verdict:** "Legality is the CAG's floor and propriety its reach; an audit confined to legality would be lawful and useless, while one that audited policy would be powerful and improper — the balance is the propriety of implementation."

- **Comptroller verdict:** "Because India's CAG audits after the money is gone, its real force is not its own pen but the parliamentary committees that turn its reports into accountability."

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Comptroller & Auditor General (CAG) (Articles 148–151) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.10 Verdict scaffolds

HIGH

Foundation · 5.11 Prelims close-option distinctions · Table 1.1

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Confusion pair	Correct discrimination
Comptroller vs Auditor-General	India's CAG is **only an Auditor-General** — no control over the **issue** of money (unlike Britain)
Reports route	Union → **President** → **Parliament**; State → **Governor** → **State legislature**
Removal	**Like a Supreme Court judge** — not at the President's pleasure
Post-office bar	**No further office** under the Union or a State
Obligatory vs discretionary audit	**Legal/regulatory** obligatory; **propriety** discretionary
Exclusively private-audited	**RBI, LIC, SBI, FCI** — the CAG is **not** their auditor (per local files)
Net proceeds	Certified **finally by the CAG** under **Art 279**
PAC vs COPU	PAC examines appropriation/finance accounts; **COPU** examines **public-undertaking** reports

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Comptroller & Auditor General (CAG) (Articles 148–151) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.11 Prelims close-option distinctions

HIGH

Foundation · 5.11 Prelims close-option distinctions · Table 1.2

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Confusion pair	Correct discrimination
Art 150 vs Art 151	**150** = form of accounts (on the CAG's advice); **151** = audit reports laid before the legislature
Appointment vs removal	Appointed by the President **alone**; removed only **like a Supreme Court judge**
Salary and expenses	The CAG's salary and the office's administrative expenses are **charged on the Consolidated Fund of India** (Art 148) — not votable by Parliament
Three kinds of audit	**Legal/regulatory**, **propriety** and **performance/efficiency** audit; only **legal/regulatory** audit is obligatory

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Comptroller & Auditor General (CAG) (Articles 148–151) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.11 Prelims close-option distinctions

HIGH

Foundation · 5.12 Factual-risk and current-status controls

GS-II Indian Polity

NEWS TRIGGER

 Arts 148–151 and **Art 279** are the CAG's constitutional anchors; the detail is in the **DPC Act 1971**. The CAG is removed **like a Supreme Court judge**, **not** at the President's pleasure, and is **barred from further office**. **Propriety audit is discretionary**; only legal/regulatory audit is obligatory — do not reverse this.

INTRO & ORIGIN

 Do not quote the "substantially financed" statutory threshold or any audit-report **loss figure** — neither is recorded in these local files; cite the mechanism and the debate instead.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

5.12 FACTUAL-RISK AND CURRENT-STATUS CONTROLS: RECALL MAP

5.12 Factual-risk and current-status controls

V

Dimension 1 Do not quote the "substantially financed" statutory threshold or any audit-report loss figure — neither is recorded in these local files; cite the	**Dimension 2** The public-corporation examples (including the exclusively-private RBI/LIC/SBI/FCI set) reflect the local files; entity status can change (privatis
Dimension 3 The collegium-appointment demand and the PPP/off-budget/PM-CARES audit-reach debates are current — tag as current and verify status before dating.	**Dimension 4** less than !-- BEGIN GENERATED PYQ INTEGRATION: 2024-2025 -→

STATIC THEORY

- The public-corporation examples (including the exclusively-private **RBI/LIC/SBI/FCI** set) reflect the local files; **entity status can change** (privatisation/mergers), so verify before dating.

- The **collegium-appointment demand** and the **PPP/off-budget/PM-CARES** audit-reach debates are current — tag as current and verify status before dating.

- less than !-- BEGIN GENERATED PYQ INTEGRATION: 2024-2025 -→

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Comptroller & Auditor General (CAG) (Articles 148–151) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 5.12 Factual-risk and current-status controls

HIGH

Foundation · Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2024	GS-II	4	CAG's duty to ensure legality and propriety of expenditure	Comment · 10 marks · 150 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Comptroller & Auditor General (CAG) (Articles 148–151) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025)

HIGH

Foundation · Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025).

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

Status: *2024-2025 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner.* ***Provenance:*** *Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2024-2025.md.* ***Years represented:*** *2024* ***Paper(s):*** *GS-II* ***Routed question demands:*** *1*

STUDY LINK

Comptroller & Auditor General (CAG) (Articles 148–151) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025)

HIGH

Foundation · What this owner must now support

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

CAG's duty to ensure legality and propriety of expenditure

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

WHAT THIS OWNER MUST NOW SUPPORT: RECALL MAP

What this owner must now support

V

Dimension 1 CAG's duty to ensure legality and propriety of expenditure	**Dimension 2** This block integrates the 2024-2025 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 block and does not convert an unkeyed
Dimension 3 less than !-- END GENERATED PYQ INTEGRATION: 2024-2025 -⟶	

STATIC THEORY

- This block integrates the 2024-2025 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 block and does not convert an unkeyed/answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

- less than !-- END GENERATED PYQ INTEGRATION: 2024-2025 -⟶

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Comptroller & Auditor General (CAG) (Articles 148–151) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → What this owner must now support

HIGH

Foundation · Semantic-completeness ownership and PYQ control

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of Semantic-completeness ownership and PYQ control.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

Constitutional/statutory map: *Articles 148-151 create and protect the single Comptroller and Auditor General; Article 149 leaves detailed duties to Parliament, chiefly the Comptroller and Auditor-General's (Duties, Powers and Conditions of Service) Act, 1971, as amended in 1976, 1984, 1987 and 1994.* ***Current officeholder:*** *the official CAG page rechecked on 5 September 2026 identifies Shri K. Sanjay Murthy, sworn in and assuming office on 21 November 2024.* ***Appointment and tenure:*** *the President appoints by warrant under hand and seal. Section 4 of the 1971 Act fixes six years or age sixty-five, whichever is earlier. Removal follows the Supreme-Court-judge process; service conditions cannot be varied to disadvantage after appointment.* ***Independence:*** *salary and administrative expenses are charged on the Consolidated Fund of India, and the CAG is ineligible for further office under the Union or a State after demitting office. The Constitution prescribes no collegium for appointment.* ***Functions:*** *audit receipts and expenditure and the three public-account funds within the statutory mandate; audit grants, substantially financed bodies, government companies and corporations through their governing legal routes; advise the President on the form of accounts under Article 150; and finally certify net proceeds under Article 279.* ***Report route:*** *Union reports go to the President for laying before Parliament; State reports go to the Governor for laying before the State legislature. PAC/COPU scrutiny and executive follow-up give reports consequence; the CAG does not itself recover, prosecute or invalidate.* ***Audit limits:*** *India's CAG does not control the issue of money and is therefore a comptroller in name but an ex-post auditor in operation. Legality/compliance audit is mandatory; propriety and performance review must not become substitution of audit judgment for lawful policy choice.* ***Classification control:*** *there is no immutable constitutional list of exactly three reports, and entity labels alone do not decide audit coverage. Apply the DPC Act, Companies Act and entity statute rather than memorised lists.* ***PYQ/ownership firewall:*** *direct 2018 appointment-powers and 2024 legality-propriety demands are owned here; Budget procedure, parliamentary committees and Finance Commission devolution remain cross-owned.*

STUDY LINK

Comptroller & Auditor General (CAG) (Articles 148–151) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Semantic-completeness ownership and PYQ control

HIGH

Advanced · Core Foundation

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Subject: Polity · **Tier:** Advanced (exam depth) · **GS Paper:** GS-II

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

CORE FOUNDATION: RECALL MAP

Core Foundation

V

Dimension 1 Subject: Polity · Tier: Advanced (exam depth) · GS Paper: GS-II	**Dimension 2** Grounded in: Indian Polity by M. Laxmikant, Ch. 51 (direct check of the local Sixth Revised Edition PDF).
Dimension 3 □ = from source book · □□ = inference / case law · □ = current affairs.	**Dimension 4** Companion: basic/CAG.md.

STATIC THEORY

- **Grounded in:** Indian Polity by M. Laxmikant, Ch. 51 (direct check of the local Sixth Revised Edition PDF).

- □ = from source book · □□ = inference / case law · □ = current affairs.

- *Companion: basic/CAG.md.*

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. = from source book · □□ = inference / case law · □ = current affairs.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Comptroller & Auditor General (CAG) (Articles 148–151) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Core Foundation

HIGH

Advanced · THE BIG PICTURE □

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ **Art 148** provides an independent **CAG** — head of the **Indian Audit & Accounts Department**, the **"guardian of the public purse." Dr. Ambedkar** called the CAG **"the most important officer under the Constitution."** One of the **bulwarks of democracy** (along with the **Supreme Court, Election Commission, UPSC**).

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Art 148 provides an independent **CAG** — head of the **Indian Audit & Accounts Department**, the **"guardian of the public purse." Dr. Ambedkar** called the CAG **"the most important officer under the Constitution."** One of the **bulwarks of democracy** (along with the **Supreme Court, Election Commission, UPSC**).

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Comptroller & Auditor General (CAG) (Articles 148–151) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → THE BIG PICTURE □

HIGH

Advanced · PART A — APPOINTMENT, TERM & REMOVAL □

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the advanced source layer.

KEY DATA

Point	Detail
□ Appointed by	**President** (warrant under hand & seal)
□ Term	**6 years or 65 years**, whichever earlier
□ Removal	Same manner as a **Supreme Court judge** (special-majority resolution of both Houses, proved misbehaviour/incapacity) — **not** during the President's pleasure
□ Resignation	To the President

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Comptroller & Auditor General (CAG) (Articles 148–151) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → PART A — APPOINTMENT, TERM & REMOVAL □

HIGH

Advanced · PART B — INDEPENDENCE □

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ **Security of tenure** (removed only by the constitutional procedure).

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

PART B — INDEPENDENCE □: RECALL MAP

PART B — INDEPENDENCE □

V

Dimension 1 □ Security of tenure (removed only by the constitutional procedure).	**Dimension 2** □ NOT eligible for any further office under the Centre or a state after his term (stricter than UPSC).
Dimension 3 □ Salary = a Supreme Court judge; determined by Parliament; can't be varied to disadvantage.	**Dimension 4** □ Salaries/expenses of the CAG's office are charged on the Consolidated Fund of India (non-votable).

STATIC THEORY

- □ **NOT eligible for any further office** under the Centre or a state after his term (stricter than UPSC).
- □ Salary = a **Supreme Court judge**; determined by Parliament; can't be varied to disadvantage.
- □ Salaries/expenses of the CAG's office are **charged on the Consolidated Fund of India** (non-votable).
- □ **No minister** can represent the CAG in Parliament or take responsibility for his actions.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. **Security of tenure** (removed only by the constitutional procedure).
2. **NOT eligible for any further office** under the Centre or a state after his term (stricter than UPSC).
3. Salary = a **Supreme Court judge**; determined by Parliament; can't be varied to disadvantage.
4. Salaries/expenses of the CAG's office are **charged on the Consolidated Fund of India** (non-votable).
5. **No minister** can represent the CAG in Parliament or take responsibility for his actions.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Comptroller & Auditor General (CAG) (Articles 148–151) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → PART B — INDEPENDENCE □

HIGH

Advanced · PART C — DUTIES & POWERS (Art 149–151) □ · Part 1

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ **CAG's (DPC) Act, 1971** (amended 1976 — separated **accounts from audit**). The CAG audits:

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

PART C — DUTIES & POWERS (ART 149–151) □: RECALL MAP

PART C — DUTIES & POWERS (Art 149–151) □

V

Dimension 1 □ CAG's (DPC) Act, 1971 (amended 1976 — separated accounts from audit). The CAG audits:	**Dimension 2** All expenditure from the Consolidated Fund of India / states / UTs-with-legislature.
Dimension 3 Contingency Fund & Public Account of India and states.	**Dimension 4** Trading/manufacturing/P&L/balance-sheet accounts of departments.

STATIC THEORY

- All expenditure from the **Consolidated Fund** of India / states / UTs-with-legislature.
- **Contingency Fund & Public Account** of India and states.
- Trading/manufacturing/P&L/balance-sheet accounts of departments.
- **Receipts & expenditure**; **bodies substantially financed** from govt revenue; **government companies** & other
- corporations (per law).
- □ **Advises the President** on the **form of accounts** (Art 150).

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. CAG's (DPC) Act, 1971 (amended 1976 — separated **accounts from audit**). The CAG audits:

2. Advises the President on the **form of accounts** (Art 150).

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Comptroller & Auditor General (CAG) (Articles 148–151) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → PART C — DUTIES & POWERS (Art 149–151) □

HIGH

Advanced · PART C — DUTIES & POWERS (Art 149–151) □ · Part 2

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ Submits audit reports on **Centre** → **President** → **Parliament (Art 151)**; on a **state → Governor → State

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

STATIC THEORY

- Legislature**.

- □ Ascertains & certifies the **net proceeds** of any tax (Art 279) — certificate is **final**.

- □ **Guide, friend & philosopher of the Public Accounts Committee (PAC)**.

- □ Audit reports include appropriation/finance-account and sector/entity-specific families. Their number and titles vary; the Constitution does not freeze an exhaustive three-report taxonomy.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Submits audit reports on **Centre** → **President** → **Parliament (Art 151)**; on a **state → Governor → State

2. Ascertains & certifies the **net proceeds** of any tax (Art 279) — certificate is **final**.

3. Guide, friend & philosopher of the Public Accounts Committee (PAC).

4. Audit reports include appropriation/finance-account and sector/entity-specific families. Their number and titles vary; the Constitution does not freeze an exhaustive three-report taxonomy.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Comptroller & Auditor General (CAG) (Articles 148–151) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → PART C — DUTIES & POWERS (Art 149–151) □

HIGH

Advanced · PART D — ROLE, TYPES OF AUDIT & LIMITATIONS □□ · Part 1

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ CAG is an independent constitutional authority whose reports enable legislative financial accountability; it is not a parliamentary officer controlled by either House.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

PART D — ROLE, TYPES OF AUDIT & LIMITATIONS □□: RECALL MAP

PART D — ROLE, TYPES OF AUDIT & LIMITATIONS □□

V

Dimension 1 □ CAG is an independent constitutional authority whose reports enable legislative financial accountability; it is not a parliamentary officer controll	**Dimension 2** □ Legal/regulatory audit (was money legally available & properly spent?) is obligatory; propriety
Dimension 3 audit (wisdom, faithfulness, economy — wastefulness/extravagance) is discretionary.	**Dimension 4** □□ Comptroller in name only: unlike Britain's CAG, India's CAG has no control over the issue of money from

STATIC THEORY

- □ **Legal/regulatory audit** (was money legally available & properly spent?) is **obligatory**; **propriety

- audit **(wisdom, faithfulness, economy — wastefulness/extravagance) is** discretionary**.

- □□ **Comptroller in name only:** unlike Britain's CAG, India's CAG has **no control over the issue of money** from

- the Consolidated Fund — he audits **after** the expenditure (Auditor-General role only, **not** Comptroller).

- □ **Secret service expenditure** is a **limitation** — he accepts a certificate from the competent authority, not

- particulars.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. CAG is an independent constitutional authority whose reports enable legislative financial accountability; it is not a parliamentary officer controlled by either House.

2. Legal/regulatory audit (was money legally available & properly spent?) is **obligatory**; **propriety

3. Secret service expenditure is a **limitation** — he accepts a certificate from the competent authority, not

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Comptroller & Auditor General (CAG) (Articles 148–151) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → PART D — ROLE, TYPES OF AUDIT & LIMITATIONS □□

HIGH

Advanced · PART D — ROLE, TYPES OF AUDIT & LIMITATIONS □□ · Part 2

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□□ **Appleby's criticism:** wanted the CAG's office abolished — called auditing "repressive/negative," a colonial

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

STATIC THEORY

- inheritance.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Comptroller & Auditor General (CAG) (Articles 148–151) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → PART D — ROLE, TYPES OF AUDIT & LIMITATIONS □□

HIGH

Advanced · CAG and public-sector entities □

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Coverage depends on legal form and the governing statute: departments follow the DPC Act; government companies use the DPC Act with Companies Act sections 139/143; statutory corporations follow their establishing laws; other bodies require a valid sections 14, 15, 16 or 20 nexus. Historical entity lists are unsafe substitutes for this legal test.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Comptroller & Auditor General (CAG) (Articles 148–151) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → CAG and public-sector entities □

HIGH

Advanced · UPSC Traps

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

comptrolling power, unlike Britain).

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: The CAG both controls and audits the Consolidated Fund

CORRECT: in practice he is **only Auditor-General** (no

WRONG: CAG audits state accounts and reports to Parliament

CORRECT: state reports go to the **Governor** → **State Legislature**.

WRONG: CAG can take another government job after retirement

CORRECT: **barred** from any further Centre/state office.

WRONG: Propriety audit is compulsory

CORRECT: it is **discretionary** (only legal/regulatory audit is obligatory).

WRONG: Every public-sector-labelled entity is audited identically

CORRECT: coverage depends on legal form, governing law and the relevant statutory gateway.

WRONG: CAG's term is fixed at 6 years only

CORRECT: **6 years or 65**, whichever earlier.

WRONG: CAG is removed by the President at pleasure

CORRECT: removed **only** like a Supreme Court judge.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Comptroller & Auditor General (CAG) (Articles 148–151) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → UPSC Traps

HIGH

Advanced · □ CA hooks

GS-II Indian Polity

NEWS TRIGGER

□ □□ Debate on bringing **PPP projects, off-budget borrowings & PM-CARES** under CAG audit — audit-jurisdiction gaps. □ □□ CAG **performance audits** (e.g., health schemes, highway-project costing) triggering accountability.

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ □□ Demand for a **collegium-style appointment** of the CAG to bolster independence (executive-only appointment

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

STATIC THEORY

- criticised).

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Comptroller & Auditor General (CAG) (Articles 148–151) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → □ CA hooks

HIGH

Advanced · Mains angles

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of Mains angles.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

"The CAG is a Comptroller only in name." Examine, comparing with the British model. Should the CAG's appointment be de-linked from the sole discretion of the executive? Propriety vs regulatory audit — how far should the CAG question the "wisdom" of policy?

STUDY LINK

Comptroller & Auditor General (CAG) (Articles 148–151) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Mains angles

HIGH

Advanced · Verified PYQ application

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of Verified PYQ application.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

2024 GS-II Q4 (10 marks, 150 words): *"The duty of the Comptroller and Auditor General is not merely to ensure the legality of expenditure but also its propriety. Comment." Route: mandatory legal/regulatory audit → discretionary propriety audit (wisdom, faithfulness and economy) → performance audit → preserve policy choice while exposing waste, conflict and avoidable expenditure. less than !-- BEGIN GENERATED PYQ INTEGRATION: 2018-2023 -->*

STUDY LINK

Comptroller & Auditor General (CAG) (Articles 148–151) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Verified PYQ application

HIGH

Advanced · Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the advanced source layer.

KEY DATA

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2018	GS-II	5	CAG appointment method terms and range of powers	Explain · 10 marks · 150 words	Routed to owning topic; printed word-limit tail OCR-corrupted in scan	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Comptroller & Auditor General (CAG) (Articles 148–151) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

HIGH

Advanced · Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023).

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE
Status: *Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner.* ***Provenance:*** *Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2018-2023.md.* ***Years represented:*** *2018* ***Paper(s):*** *GS-II* ***Routed question demands:*** *1*

STUDY LINK
Comptroller & Auditor General (CAG) (Articles 148–151) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

HIGH

Advanced · What this owner must now support

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

CAG appointment method terms and range of powers

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

WHAT THIS OWNER MUST NOW SUPPORT: RECALL MAP

What this owner must now support

V

Dimension 1 CAG appointment method terms and range of powers	**Dimension 2** The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not cl
Dimension 3 less than !-- END GENERATED PYQ INTEGRATION: 2018-2023 -—›	

STATIC THEORY

- The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

- less than !-- END GENERATED PYQ INTEGRATION: 2018-2023 -—›

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Comptroller & Auditor General (CAG) (Articles 148–151) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → What this owner must now support

End of Register Notes - UPSC Agent / Copilot CLI